

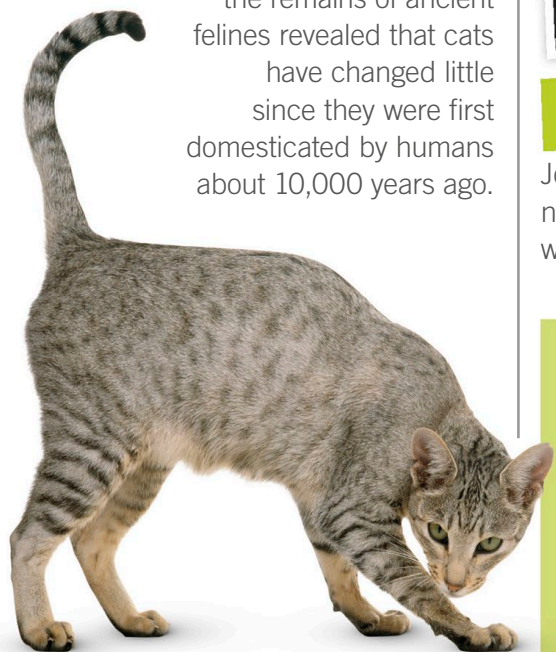
June

19

2017

Studying cats

Researchers studying the remains of ancient felines revealed that cats have changed little since they were first domesticated by humans about 10,000 years ago.



Born this day

1978 Dirk Werner Nowitzki, German basketball player. He is considered one of the greatest European players.

1978 Zoe Saldana, US actor. She has played memorable characters in blockbusters such as *Avatar* and several of the Marvel Cinematic Universe films.



1905

The first cinema

In their shop in Pittsburgh, USA, John P Harris and Harry Davis set up the first nickelodeon – a cinema where people could watch “moving pictures” for five cents (a nickel).

Also on this day

1865 At the end of the US Civil War, Texas was one of the last states to announce that all enslaved people were now free. The day is now celebrated nationwide as Juneteenth.

1910 In Germany, the airship *Deutschland*, the world's first commercial passenger aircraft, took to the skies on its first flight.

1913 The white minority government in South Africa passed the Natives Land Act, restricting the land rights of the majority Black population.

1846

Baseball first

In the first officially recorded game of modern baseball, a team called the New York Nine smashed the Knickerbockers 23–1 in Hoboken, New Jersey, USA.